

Chapter : 3

Business Communication
and the global Context

Globalization:-

The process of increasing the connectivity and interdependence of the world's market and business is called globalization. In globalization understanding others culture is very important.

Culture:- *past paper*

Culture refers to the behavioral characteristics typical of a group. This implies that communications, oral and nonverbal within a group are often unique.

- For example, in Chinese culture people sign their last name first.

- In German culture two signature appears at the bottom of the business letter.

- In Europe people write day first then month.

post paper

in which two or more cultures are involved

communication

between people

in two

level

structure

Intercultural Communication:-

Intercultural

Communication is the form of

communication that aims to

share information across

different cultures and social

groups. It is used to

describe the wide range of

communication processes and

problems that naturally

appears within an organization

or social context made

up of individuals from

different religious, social

and education background

According to

interculture model we feel

more comfortable with those

people who have same

beliefs.

(73) (17)

National Cultural Variables:-

An entire

country may have a

series of cultural norms,

individual within the country

most of those

norms as well as adding their own national cultural variables are;

- Education ✓
- Law and Regulations ✓
- Economics ✓
- Politics ✓
- Religion ✓
- Social Norms ✓
- Language ✓

Educations:-

For example:-
Education level of Chinese, Asian & U.S. Managers.

Highest level of education	Chinese %	Asian %	U.S. %
⇒ less than high school	5.4	2.5	0.1
⇒ High school graduate	31.8	12.4	3.2
⇒ Some college	34.6	19.4	16.9
⇒ Undergraduate college	27.6	65.4	79.8
⇒ Postgraduate college	0.7	25.0	30.0

Communication depends upon education. One should be aware of the fact about the education level of the other person one is speaking to. Management education including training in business communication, is more prevalent in the United States than in other countries. Some countries have no academic courses in communication training.

For example, in China and most Asian countries managers have less formal

education than those in Europe and America

Law and regulations:-

In both developed and underdeveloped countries, various government regulations affect business communication and the sale of the product. For example cigarettes cannot be advertised in Europe. No fashion magazines are allowed in Iran

Economics:-

Economics is also a national cultural variable which measures the availability of capital and transportation and the standard of living per capita which is vary from one nation to another nation

It also measures the opportunity to borrow money, the rate of inflation and the exchange rate. These factors influence businesses and country's ability to

Communicate concerning that business. For example in the Pakistan the competitors usually set their own prices.

Politics:-

Politics also effect our communication when we are doing business with our company can result even in personal harm. Concept of democracy will vary as interpreted in Korea,

The sweeping political changes in Eastern Europe and its altered concepts of government will effect future business world-wide.

Religion:-

Religion is a national cultural variable for which an individual must be careful about religious belief especially in foreign countries. Although some basic beliefs overlaps, there are major differences that if not understood can result

even in personal harm
Most countries have
religious holidays, and these
holidays affect international
communication and also
interrupting work schedules.

Language:-

Every body knows
that knowing the language
of a country is most
important and significant
contribute to improved communication
on personal and business level.
Our communication is
good when both sender and
receiver have same language.
English is a world language
and a major extent the
language of business.

Social Norms:-

In various ways
any national environment, education
rules and regulations, economics,
political environment and the
religion affect a nation's
social norms.

In many countries

a male line of the family profoundly influences some business decisions. It also includes how members relate to one another, what is their buying pattern etc.

Individual Cultural variables

Individual cultural variables are;

- Time
- Space
- Food
- Acceptable Dress
- Manners
- Decision making
- verbal and non-verbal communication

cultural variable is the variation in attitude, experience and values between individuals from different culture.

Time:-

Time is most important factor in communication. For example Germans are time precise people rarely do wait for an appointment in Germany.

In Latin culture people may wait an hour and the host does not show disrespect thereby. In Pakistan

arriving late is socially
accepted custom.

Space:-

Culture also differ in
regard to how they perceive
and use physical spaces,
Specifically private and public
space.

In private space culture
personal space is valued, and
clear borders and boundaries
exist between one space and
another. Ownership of space is
important. Doors are to be
closed and knocking before
entering is expected.

In public space culture
spaces are weaker and more
flexible. Space is shared
rather than owned. Doors
are kept to be opened and
access is free.

Food:-

People of different
societies have different taste
for food. It has importance
in the communication.

one should be very careful
about food before going in
any country. Like muslims
have to take great care
in choosing Halal food
before eating in any
foreign country.

Acceptable Dress:-

The dress of
individuals also tell a great
deal about that person and
his culture while communicating.
For example when a person
gives a speech in a
Seminar, it is must for
him to wear clean clothes
and according to custom
of that country.

A good dress
always conveys a clean non-
verbal message. If one wears
clothes according to the
cultures of the country
this will attract the persons
of that country.

Manners:-

Manners also have value in communication. So one should be aware of manner of culture to whom he is communicating. In Europe one brings gift when visiting homes. On the other hand red roses are avoided in France, Germany etc. In Saudi Arabia one must learn that junior prince is silent when the senior enters.

Decision Making:-

Decision making may be lengthy process while doing business with other countries. So one must have patience above all in intercultural communication.

In American culture Americans are typecast as moving too quickly in asking for a decision.

* (verbal) + (non verbal)